MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION November 2025

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCBAJ100 -
ART OF PUBLIC SPEAKING KEY Maximum Marks: 35

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Part A

SHORT ANSWERS Answer any **10** questions, Each question carries **1** marks

1. **Identify any two barriers to good communication. [K] / [CO2]**
   Two common barriers to effective communication are:
   a) Physical Barriers : These are obstacles in the environment that interfere with the transmission of a message. **Examples:** Noise, distance, poor lighting, or any environmental condition that disrupts communication.
   b) Psychological Barriers: These relate to the emotional or mental state of the communicator, which affects how messages are sent or received.
   Examples: Stress, fear, anxiety,preconceived notions, or emotional bias.

2. **Discuss Why is it important to check your timing and pronunciation before giving a presentation? [U] / [CO4]**
   It is important to check timing to ensure the speech stays within the set time limit. It is important to check pronunciation because proper pronunciation is a basic skill that ensures the speaker's voice is clear and helps improve voice control. It is also important to check your pronunciation because clear and correct pronunciation ensures that the audience understands your message.

3. **Explain how clarity and energy help an anchor perform effectively during an event [U] / [CO5]**
   Clarity (using a clear and loud voice, and simple language) helps an anchor perform effectively by ensuring the audience easily understands the program's flow. Energy (confidence and enthusiasm) helps the anchor keep the audience interested and creates a positive, engaging atmosphere for the event.

4. **Define the main goals of public speaking and list its four primary purposes. [U] / [CO2]**
   The main goal of public speaking is to communicate messages clearly to a group. The four primary purposes are: To Inform, To Persuade, To Entertain, and To Motivate**.**

5. **Explain why a speaker should adapt their language to suit different types of audiences.** [U] / [CO4]
   A speaker should adapt their language to suit different types of audiences because not all listeners have the same level of knowledge, background, or understanding. Using language that matches the audience's age, education level, culture, and interests ensures that the message is easily understood. Adapting language also helps maintain audience engagement, prevents

misunderstandings, and makes the communication more effective. When the language is appropriate for the audience, the speaker builds better connection, clarity, and credibility.

6. **Explain how using the right tone helps a speaker make their message clear and meaningful to the audience. [U] / [CO5]**

   The right tone (vocal expression/pitch) helps a speaker by allowing them to express emotions naturally. Using the right tone helps a speaker express emotions clearly, highlight important ideas, and keep the audience engaged. It shows the speaker's attitude, prevents misunderstandings, and makes the message more meaningful and easier to remember.

7. **Define the term emotional appeal in public speaking [U] / [**CO2]

   Emotional appeal is a public speaking technique used to inspire people to take action or change their mindset by connecting with their feelings (e.g., happiness, concern, excitement). It is crucial in motivational and persuasive speaking to influence opinions and decisions. It helps the audience relate to the topic on a personal level.

8. **Discuss why a strong closing is important for audience recall. [U] / [CO4]**

   A strong closing (conclusion) is important for audience recall because this is the section where the speaker summarizes the main points and provides a final message. The conclusion acts as the last and most emphasized part of the speech, which is essential for memory and retention.

9. **Explain gestures, give examples of hand or body gestures that can emphasize key points and make your speech more effective. [U] / [CO5]**
   Gestures are movements of the hands, arms, and body that happen while you speak to illustrate points and emphasize key words. Examples: Spreading your arms wide to show size or success (e.g., "a huge success"), or using the left hand for one point and the right hand to contrast two ideas.

10. **Identify two common barriers that prevent effective listening in communication. [U] / [CO4]**
    Two common barriers that prevent effective listening are: Physical Barriers (like Noise or poor seating, language issues) and Psychological Barriers (like Stress, prejudice, or lack of interest in the topic).

11. **Classify the following speech types: and explain briefly a) speech on Independence Day, b) speech on saving water, briefly explain those speech [U] / [CO2]**

    a) Speech on Independence Day Type: Ceremonial / Special-occasion speech
    Explanation: This speech is delivered during national celebrations. It focuses on patriotism, national pride, history, and honouring freedom fighters. The purpose is to inspire the audience and create a sense of unity and patriotism.

    b) Speech on Saving Water .Type: Persuasive speech
    Explanation:This speech aims to convince people to use water wisely. It explains the

importance of water conservation and encourages the audience to adopt responsible habits like reducing wastage and protecting water resources.

12. Discuss how interviews can help you gather authentic information for your speech. [U] / [CO4]

Interviews help a speaker get **real, first-hand, and reliable information** directly from experts or people with experience. They provide accurate facts, personal stories, and professional opinions that make the speech more trustworthy and interesting. Interviews also allow the speaker to ask specific questions and clarify doubts, which improves the quality and depth of the content.

Part B - Short Essay Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. Explain the four main types of speech delivery and give an example of each. [U] / [CO5]

The four main modes of speech delivery are:

1. **Read** (Manuscript Mode): The speaker reads the entire speech word-for-word from a prepared text. It is used when absolute accuracy of language and data is required. Example: A newsreader reads the news script.
2. **Memorized Mode**: The speaker learns the entire speech by heart and delivers it without notes. Used primarily for very short, formal speeches where perfection is desired. Example: A student reciting a memorized poem.
3. **Impromptu Mode**: Speaking without planning or preparation. Used when a speaker is called upon suddenly for short comments or answers. Example: A student speaking immediately after a teacher asks, "What do you think on this topic?"
4. **Extempore** / Speaking with Notes: The speaker thoroughly prepares and researches the topic but uses only brief notes or outlines to guide the delivery. This is the most common and preferred mode. Example: Delivering a class presentation or a business meeting speech.

14. Explain the main differences between informative, persuasive, and special occasion speeches, giving one key feature of each type. [A] / [CO4]

- **Informative Speech**: The goal is to provide useful knowledge or facts to the audience. Key Feature: Success depends on the clarity and accuracy of the information presented.
- **Persuasive Speech**: The goal is to influence people's opinions, beliefs, or decisions to change their mindset. Key Feature: The objective is to make the audience agree or take a particular action.
- **Special Occasion (Ceremonial) Speech**: The goal is to celebrate, honor, or appreciate people and events. Key Feature: The primary purpose is to express emotions such as joy, respect, or gratitude.

15. Describe how tone, body language, and enthusiasm contribute to confident and engaging speech delivery. [U] / [CO2]

- **Tone**: A controlled pitch and volume makes the speaker sound confident and professional. Varying the tone and raising the voice for important points keeps the speech from being monotonous, thereby making it more engaging.
- **Body Language**: Good posture projects confidence and professionalism. Using gestures and maintaining eye contact helps the audience connect with the message, making the delivery more lively and engaging.
- **Enthusiasm**: Confidence and enthusiasm are crucial qualities that help capture the audience's attention and maintain their interest. By expressing emotions naturally and sounding genuinely excited, the speech becomes more powerful and inspiring.

16. Explain basic rules for using visual aids effectively and avoiding common mistakes. [U] / [CO5]

Basic Rules for Effective Use:

1. Visual aids should be used as tools to help the audience understand the information better and faster. They must make your speech clear, interesting, and memorable.
2. Keep images and charts simple and easy to read; a picture should often explain more than a minute of speaking.

Common Mistakes to Avoid:

1. Overcrowding: Do not use charts or slides with too many lines or small text, as they become difficult to read quickly.
2. Avoid using the visual aid as a script; a speaker should not read directly from the slides.

17. Explain how a speaker can adjust the content and tone of a speech to suit the audience's age, background, and level of understanding. [A] / [CO4]

The speaker must perform audience analysis to make these adjustments:

- Content Adjustment: The speaker must choose the right examples and stories that the audience can relate to based on their age and background. The level of detail should match their understanding, meaning complex information may need to be simplified for a general audience.
- Tone and Language Adjustment: The speaker must use a tone that is suitable (e.g., serious vs. motivational). The language should be simple and clear, and the speaker must avoid technical terms (jargon) unless they are properly explained, to ensure the message is accessible to everyone regardless of their background.

18. Describe how public speaking is different from casual conversation. [U] / [CO2]

Public speaking (speaking to a group) differs from casual conversation (talking to one person) in these key ways:

- Interaction: Public speaking involves limited interaction and is mostly one-way, while conversation is direct and personal, a two-way exchange.

- Preparation: Public speaking requires planning, organization, and practice, while conversation is usually spontaneous.
- Tone and Language: Public speaking is typically formal or semi-formal and structured, while conversation is informal and conversational.
- Feedback: Feedback in public speaking is often delayed or generalized (from audience reactions), while in conversation, it is immediate.

19. Give an example of a speech topic suitable for a school assembly [A] / [CO4]

A speech topic suitable for a school assembly is "Time Management for Students." (Other examples that are relevant to students include: "Healthy Snacks for Students" or "Benefits of Playing Football").

20. Describe how to choose a simple and interesting topic for a speech. [U] / [CO2]

Selecting a Speech Topic

Choosing a speech topic is the first and most important step in preparing a good speech. A good topic should be interesting to you and relevant to the audience. Pick something you know about or are willing to learn more about. The topic should also match the purpose of your speech—whether it is to inform, persuade, or entertain.

- **Personal interest** – Choose something you enjoy, like music or travel. Example: If you like cooking, you can speak about "Healthy Snacks for Students."
- **Audience interest** – Pick a topic suitable for the listeners. Example: For classmates, "Time Management for Students" works well.
- **Knowledge level** – Select a topic you understand. If you know about sports, choose "Benefits of Playing Football."

Research also helps you choose a good speech topic because it shows whether there is enough correct information available. By checking books, websites, and talking to people, you can find out which topics you can explain easily. It also helps you pick a topic that is interesting and true, so your speech becomes clear and trustworthy.

A clear topic makes the speech easier to prepare and deliver.